

Hypertension: An Overview

Hypertension, commonly known as high blood pressure, is a chronic medical condition in which the force of blood against the artery walls is consistently too high.

It is often called the 'silent killer' because it may not show noticeable symptoms but can lead to serious health complications.

Normal blood pressure is typically around 120/80 mmHg, while hypertension is diagnosed when readings consistently exceed 130/80 mmHg.

Causes and Risk Factors

Hypertension can be classified as primary (essential) or secondary. Primary hypertension develops over time without a specific cause.

Secondary hypertension results from underlying conditions such as kidney disease or hormonal disorders.

Risk factors include unhealthy diet, high salt intake, lack of physical activity, obesity, smoking, stress, and genetic predisposition.

Symptoms and Complications

Most people with hypertension do not experience symptoms, which makes regular monitoring important.

In severe cases, symptoms may include headaches, dizziness, shortness of breath, and nosebleeds.

If left untreated, hypertension can lead to complications such as heart disease, stroke, kidney damage, and vision problems.

Prevention and Management

Lifestyle changes are key to managing hypertension. These include maintaining a balanced diet, reducing salt intake, and exercising regularly.

Avoiding smoking and limiting alcohol consumption also help control blood pressure levels.

Medications may be prescribed by healthcare professionals to manage the condition effectively.

Regular check-ups and monitoring are essential for long-term health.